



thwarted Norris' attempt to catch him, grabbing a fourth successive drivers' crown. Verstappen, after a brilliant comeback in Brazil and an anti-climactic sixth-place finish in Las Vegas, protected his position and established himself among the greatest in the sport.

While Verstappen won nine of the 24 races, seven different drivers won more than a race apiece, making it a dynamic season. Some of the major podium wins included Lando Norris' first F1 win (Miami), Ferrari's Charles Leclerc breaking his Monaco curse, and Mercedes' Lewis Hamilton standing on the top step after 945 days, securing a record ninth victory at Silverstone.

However, there were plenty of moments apart from race results that



A close contest: While Verstappen won nine of the 24 races, seven different drivers won more than a race apiece, making it a dynamic season.

GETTY IMAGES

stole the spotlight. Only into the second race weekend, super-sub Oliver Bearman (**left**) was the talk of the town after filling in for a recovering Carlos Sainz in Saudi Arabia and finishing in the points on debut. The F2 driver was also part of another successful race for Haas — after Kevin Magnussen was handed a race ban — and will start his first full season with the team in 2025.

Often referred to as the 'silly season', the driver swap phenomenon continued as veteran

GETTY IMAGES